



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE

National Police College of Jamaica Operational Continuity Policy and Standard Operating Procedures

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1.0 Introduction

Recognizing the critical role of uninterrupted training, education, and administrative functions, the National Police College of Jamaica (NPCJ) has developed this Operational Continuity Policy (OCP) to establish clear strategies, resource allocations, and procedures necessary to maintain essential functions during and after emergencies or crises.

Operational continuity is essential to NPCJ's mission of providing high-quality training for law enforcement professionals and ensuring a safe learning environment. Given the unpredictable nature of disruptions, whether due to natural disasters, technological failures, security incidents, or health emergencies, this policy provides a structured approach to risk management, preparedness, response, and recovery to ensure the continuity of its operations in the event of a disruption. It aligns with national emergency management frameworks and international best practices to enhance NPCJ's resilience against potential threats.

2.0 Scope

This policy and standard operating procedures applies to operations of all NPCJ locations, including administrative offices, training facilities, and dormitories. It covers responses to natural disasters, technological failures, security incidents, and health emergencies.

3.0 Purpose

The National Police College of Jamaica (NPCJ) is dedicated to maintaining a safe and secure environment for its personnel, students, and visitors. This policy statement outlines our commitment to operational continuity and emergency management to ensure the uninterrupted delivery of our educational and training programmes in the face of various disruptions.

4.0 Policy Statement

It is the policy of the National Police College of Jamaica that, during operation disruptions:

- 4.1.1 the safety and wellbeing of all personnel, students, and visitors will be systematically ensured;
- 4.1.2 critical operations and services will be maintain;
- 4.1.3 the impact of disruptions on NPCJ's educational and training programmes will be minimized;
- 4.1.4 swift and efficient recovery to normal operations will be facilitate; and
- 4.1.5 the NPCJ's framework for risk assessment and mitigation will be maintained.

5.0 Abbreviations & Acronyms

ACP	Assistant Commissioner of Police
C-TOC	Counter Terrorism & Organized Crime Investigations Branch

ICTD	Information Communication and Technology Division
IT	Information Technology
JCF	Jamaica Constabulary Force
JDF	Jamaica Defence Force
NPCJ	National Police College of Jamaica
OCP	Operational Continuity Policy
ODPEM	Office of Disaster Preparedness and Emergency Management
PECC	Police Emergency Communication Centre
PPE	Personal Protective Equipment

6.0 Definitions

- 6.1 **Critical Functions:** Essential services and operations, including training delivery, administrative processes, and IT infrastructure support, must be maintained during a disruption
- 6.2 **Emergency Preparedness:** Proactive measures taken to equip personnel and students with the necessary training, resources, and protocols to respond effectively to crises.
- 6.3 **Health Emergencies:** Public health crises such as pandemics and disease outbreaks necessitating immediate response and mitigation measures.
- 6.4 **Mitigation Strategies:** Preventive actions aimed at reducing vulnerabilities and minimizing the risks associated with potential threats.
- 6.5 **Natural Disasters:** Events such as hurricanes, earthquakes, and floods that may cause significant damage to NPCJ's infrastructure and operations.
- 6.6 **Operational Continuity Plan (OCP):** A structured framework that outlines measures to ensure the uninterrupted functioning of NPCJ's essential operations during and after disruptions.
- 6.7 **Response and Recovery Procedures:** Coordinated actions to mitigate the impact of disruptions, ensure safety, restore critical functions, and facilitate a return to normalcy.
- 6.8 **Risk Assessment:** A systematic process of identifying, analyzing, and evaluating potential hazards that could impact NPCJ's operational functions.
- 6.9 **Security Incidents:** Situations involving terrorist attacks, civil unrest, or internal security breaches that pose threats to NPCJ personnel, students, and facilities.

- 6.10 **Technological Failures:** Disruptions caused by power outages, cyber-attacks, or communication breakdowns that affect IT systems and operational capabilities.

7.0 Responsibilities

7.1 The Assistant Commissioner of Police Training will:

- 7.1.1 provide strategic leadership and oversight for all aspects of this policy and standard operating procedures;
- 7.1.2 act as the primary liaison with external agencies, including local law enforcement, emergency services, and government bodies;
- 7.1.3 coordinate multi-agency collaboration and resource-sharing;
- 7.1.4 allocate necessary resources, including staffing, equipment, and supplies, to support the implementation of this policy and standard operating procedures;
- 7.1.5 oversee regular risk assessments to identify potential threats and vulnerabilities;
- 7.1.6 oversee the planning and execution of regular drills and exercises to test the effectiveness of this policy and standard operating procedures;
- 7.1.7 oversee the recovery process, including damage assessment, restoration of services, and post-incident reviews; and
- 7.1.8 ensure compliance with all relevant laws, regulations, continuity and emergency management guidelines.

7.2 Heads of Faculties and Departments will:

- 7.2.1 ensure departmental compliance with the Operational Continuity Policy and Standard Operating Procedures. and related policies;
- 7.2.2 communicate the importance of this policy and standard operating procedures to departmental staff;
- 7.2.3 identify and prioritize critical departmental functions;
- 7.2.4 develop and implement department-specific continuity strategies and procedures;
- 7.2.5 coordinate response and recovery efforts during and after emergencies;
- 7.2.6 ensure the availability of necessary resources (e.g. equipment, supplies) to support continuity efforts; and
- 7.2.7 maintain an inventory of critical assets and ensure their protection during emergencies.

7.3 Members of Staff will:

- 7.3.1 participate actively in all training sessions and emergency drills;
- 7.3.2 familiarize themselves with the SOPs for different types of emergencies;
- 7.3.3 follow established emergency procedures and protocols during an incident;
- 7.3.4 report any suspicious activity or security concerns immediately to the appropriate authorities;
- 7.3.5 maintain personal preparedness, including knowing evacuation routes and assembly points; and
- 7.3.6 ensure personal contact information is updated in the NPCJ emergency contact system.

8.0 Roles and Functions

8.1 Risk Management Team will:

- 8.1.1 develop, implement, and maintain the Operational Continuity Policy and Standard Operating Procedures;
- 8.1.2 identify critical functions and prioritize their continuation during disruptions;
- 8.1.3 work with local authorities and emergency services to ensure a cohesive response;
- 8.1.4 coordinate and conduct regular training sessions and emergency drills for all staff and students;
- 8.1.5 ensure that all personnel are familiar with emergency procedures;
- 8.1.6 conduct regular evacuation drills and ensure all personnel know evacuation routes and procedures;
- 8.1.7 regularly review and update the Operational Continuity Policy and Standard Operating Procedures based on lessons learned and best practices;
- 8.1.8 conduct risk assessments and update protocols in line with national guidelines; and
- 8.1.9 conduct post-incident reviews to identify areas for improvement.

8.2 IT Department will:

- 8.2.1 implement and maintain robust cybersecurity measures (e.g., firewalls, anti-virus software);
- 8.2.2 conduct regular security assessments and updates to IT infrastructure;
- 8.2.3 ensure regular backups of critical data and systems;
- 8.2.4 develop and implement disaster recovery plans for IT systems; and
- 8.2.5 provide technical support during emergencies to ensure continuity of critical IT functions;

- 8.2.6 **Property Management and Logistics Department will:**
- 8.2.7 ensure the structural integrity and safety of all NPCJ buildings;
- 8.2.8 conduct regular inspections and maintenance of facilities;
- 8.2.9 maintain an inventory of emergency supplies (e.g., food, water, medical supplies);
- 8.2.10 ensure accessibility and proper storage of emergency supplies; and
- 8.2.11 develop and maintain evacuation plans for all buildings.

9.0 Standard Operating Procedures

During emergencies/disruptions, continuity of operations at the NPCJ will be managed in accordance with the following guidelines:

9.1 Risk Assessment

Periodic assessments should be conducted to identify potential risks and vulnerabilities that could impact NPCJ operations. Additionally,

9.2 Preparation and Response to Natural Disasters

9.2.1 Hurricanes

9.2.1.1 Preparation

- i. Monitor weather updates from the Meteorological Service of Jamaica.
- ii. Pass warnings to all personnel at NPCJ including occupants of the Government Quarters
- iii. Secure all buildings and facilities (shutter windows, reinforce doors).
- iv. Ensure emergency supplies are stocked for recruits and staff (food, water, medical supplies, flashlights, batteries).
- v. Identify and prepare safe zones for shelter within NPCJ
- vi. Safeguard electronic equipment such as computers, printers, etc

9.2.1.2 During

- i. Move all personnel and students to designated safe zones.
- ii. Maintain communication with the Office of Disaster Preparedness and Emergency Management (ODPEM) and Police Emergency Communication Centre (PECC).
- iii. Monitor the situation continuously and provide updates to all staff and students.
- iv. Follow instructions from emergency services.

9.2.1.3 After

- i. Conduct a headcount to ensure everyone is safe and accounted for.
- ii. Assess damage to facilities and infrastructure.
- iii. Report damage and initiate repair protocols.
- iv. Communicate recovery plans and expected timelines.

9.2.2 Earthquakes

9.2.2.1 Preparation

- i. Conduct regular earthquake drills.
- ii. Secure heavy equipment and furniture to prevent tipping.
- iii. Identify safe spots within buildings (under sturdy furniture, away from windows).

9.2.2.2 During

- i. Instruct everyone to drop, cover, and hold on.
- ii. Stay indoors if already inside, and avoid doorways.
- iii. If outdoors, move away from buildings, trees, and utility wires.

9.2.2.3 After

- i. Evacuate buildings once shaking stops and it is safe to do so.
- ii. Conduct headcounts and ensure the safety of all personnel and students.
- iii. Assess for injuries and provide first aid.
- iv. Inspect buildings for damage before allowing re-entry.
- v. Communicate with ODPEM and await further instructions.

9.2.3 Floods

9.2.3.1 Preparation

- i. Monitor weather forecasts and warnings.
- ii. Ensure emergency supplies are accessible and elevated.
- iii. Move critical equipment and documents to higher ground.

9.2.3.2 During

- i. Move to higher floors or designated safe zones.
- ii. Avoid walking or driving through floodwaters.

- iii. Maintain communication with local emergency services.

9.2.3.3 After

- i. Conduct a headcount to ensure everyone's safety.
- ii. Assess and document damage to facilities and infrastructure.
- iii. Initiate clean-up and recovery procedures.
- iv. Ensure water and food safety.

9.2.4 Preparation and Response to Technological Failures

9.2.4.1 Power Outage

9.2.4.1.1 Preparation

- i. Maintain an inventory of backup power sources (generators, batteries).
- ii. Ensure critical systems have uninterruptible power supplies (UPS).

9.2.4.1.2 During

- i. Activate backup power sources as needed.
- ii. Notify all personnel of the outage and expected duration.
- iii. Minimize non-essential power usage to conserve energy.

9.2.4.1.3 After

- i. Restore normal power and shutdown backup systems.
- ii. Inspect and test all systems to ensure functionality.
- iii. Report any damages or issues caused by the outage.

9.2.4.2 Cyber-Attacks

9.2.4.2.1 Preparation

- i. Implement robust cybersecurity measures (firewalls, anti-virus software, regular updates).
- ii. Conduct regular cybersecurity training for staff.
- iii. Establish incident response teams.

9.2.4.2.2 During

- i. Isolate affected systems to prevent further spread.
- ii. Notify NPCJ's IT department and Information Communication and Technology Division (ICTD) teams immediately.
- iii. Follow the incident response protocol to identify, contain, and mitigate the attack.

9.2.4.2.3 After

- i. Conduct a thorough investigation to determine the breach's cause and impact.
- ii. Restore systems from clean backups.
- iii. Update security protocols to prevent future incidents.
- iv. Communicate with affected parties and authorities as necessary.

9.2.4.3 Communication Breakdowns

9.2.4.3.1 Preparation

- i. Maintain multiple communication channels (landlines, mobile phones, radios).
- ii. Develop an emergency communication plan.

9.2.4.3.2 During

- i. Switch to alternative communication methods.
- ii. Notify all personnel of the communication breakdown.
- iii. Ensure essential communications are prioritized.

9.2.4.3.3 After

- i. Restore primary communication systems.
- ii. Test and verify all communication channels.
- iii. Report and address any issues identified during the breakdown.

9.2.5 Preparation and Response to Security Incidents

9.2.5.1 Terrorist Attacks

9.2.5.1.1 Preparation

- i. Conduct regular training on these security protocols.
- ii. Maintain a heightened state of awareness and vigilance.
- iii. Establish communication links with PECC.

9.2.5.1.2 During

- i. Initiate lockdown procedures immediately.
- ii. Notify PECC and follow their instructions.
- iii. Keep all personnel and students informed without causing panic.

9.2.5.1.3 After

- i. Conduct headcounts and ensure everyone's safety.
- ii. Provide information to the Counter Terrorism & Organized Crime Investigations Branch (C-TOC) to assist with investigations.
- iii. Provide counselling and support to those affected.
- iv. Review and update security protocols based on lessons learned.

9.2.5.2 Civil Unrest

9.2.5.2.1 Preparation

- i. Monitor local news and social media for signs of unrest.
- ii. Establish clear communication channels with PECC and Police High Command.
- iii. Communicate with the Special Operations Branch, Jamaica Defence Force to deploy members to assist in cordoning and crowd control.

9.2.5.2.2 During

- i. Implement lockdown procedures, if necessary.
- ii. Deploy staff appropriately to engage in operations
- iii. Keep civilian personnel and students indoors or provide escort to a safe location.
- iv. Maintain open communication with nearby divisions and PECC.

9.2.5.2.3 After

- i. Ensure everyone's safety and conduct headcounts.
- ii. Assess any damage and document incidents.
- iii. Coordinate with PECC for continued safety measures.
- iv. Review and update procedures for future incidents.

9.2.5.3 Internal Security Breaches

9.2.5.3.1 Preparation

- i. Conduct regular security assessments.

- ii. Upskill staff on recognizing and reporting suspicious activity.

9.2.5.3.2 During

- i. Isolate the affected area and initiate lockdown if necessary.
- ii. Notify internal security and follow response protocols.
- iii. Conduct an immediate investigation to identify the breach.

9.2.5.5.3 After

- i. Assess and document any damages or losses.
- ii. Implement corrective measures to prevent future breaches.
- iii. Provide support and counselling to affected individuals.
- iv. Review and update security protocols.

9.2.6 Health Emergencies

9.2.6.1 Pandemics

9.2.6.1.1 Preparation

- i. Maintain and update the following health emergency, safety and hygiene protocols in accordance with health concerns emanating from the Ministry of Health and Wellness.
- ii. Develop and disseminate health and safety guidelines.
- iii. Ensure availability of medical supplies and personal protective equipment (PPE).
- iv. Establish protocols for remote learning and work (see NPCJ Virtual School Guides).

9.2.6.1.2 During

- i. Enforce health and safety guidelines (mask-wearing, social distancing).
- ii. Monitor health conditions of personnel and students regularly.
- iii. Isolate and provide care for infected individuals.
- iv. Transition to remote operations as necessary.

9.2.6.1.3 After

- i. Conduct thorough cleaning and disinfection of facilities.
- ii. Monitor health conditions to prevent resurgence.
- iii. Provide support and counselling for those affected.
- iv. Review the health emergency, safety and hygiene protocols.

9.2.6.2 Disease Outbreaks

9.2.6.2.1 Preparation

- i. Maintain updated health emergency, safety and hygiene protocols in accordance with health concerns emanating from the Ministry of Health and Wellness.
- ii. Ensure readiness of medical facilities and supplies.

9.2.6.3.2 During:

- i. Identify and isolate affected individuals.
- ii. Implement contact tracing and monitoring.
- iii. Communicate with health authorities and follow their guidelines.

9.2.6.3.3 After:

- i. Ensure thorough cleaning and disinfection.
- ii. Monitor for any signs of recurrence.
- iii. Provide health education and support.
- iv. Review and refine outbreak response protocols.

9.2.7 Recovery Procedures

9.2.7.1 Damage Assessment and Restoration of Services

- i. assessment of the impact on facilities equipment, and operations will be conducted;
- ii. findings and recommendations will be report to NPCJ's leadership and Police High Command.
- iii. all damages and losses will be documented;
- iv. the restoration of critical functions and services will be prioritized;
- v. temporary solutions will be implement, if necessary;

- vi. progress and updates will be communicated to all stakeholders; and
- vii. post-incident review will be conducted to identify strengths and areas for improvement.

10.0 LEGISLATIVE AUTHORITY/GUIDING PRINCIPLES

- 10.1 Riot Act, 1969
- 10.2 Public Order Act, 1857;
- 10.3 Disaster Risk Management Act, 2015
- 10.4 Towns and Communities Act, 1957
- 10.5 JCF Hurricane Standing Orders;
- 10.6 National Police College of Jamaica Risk Management Policy